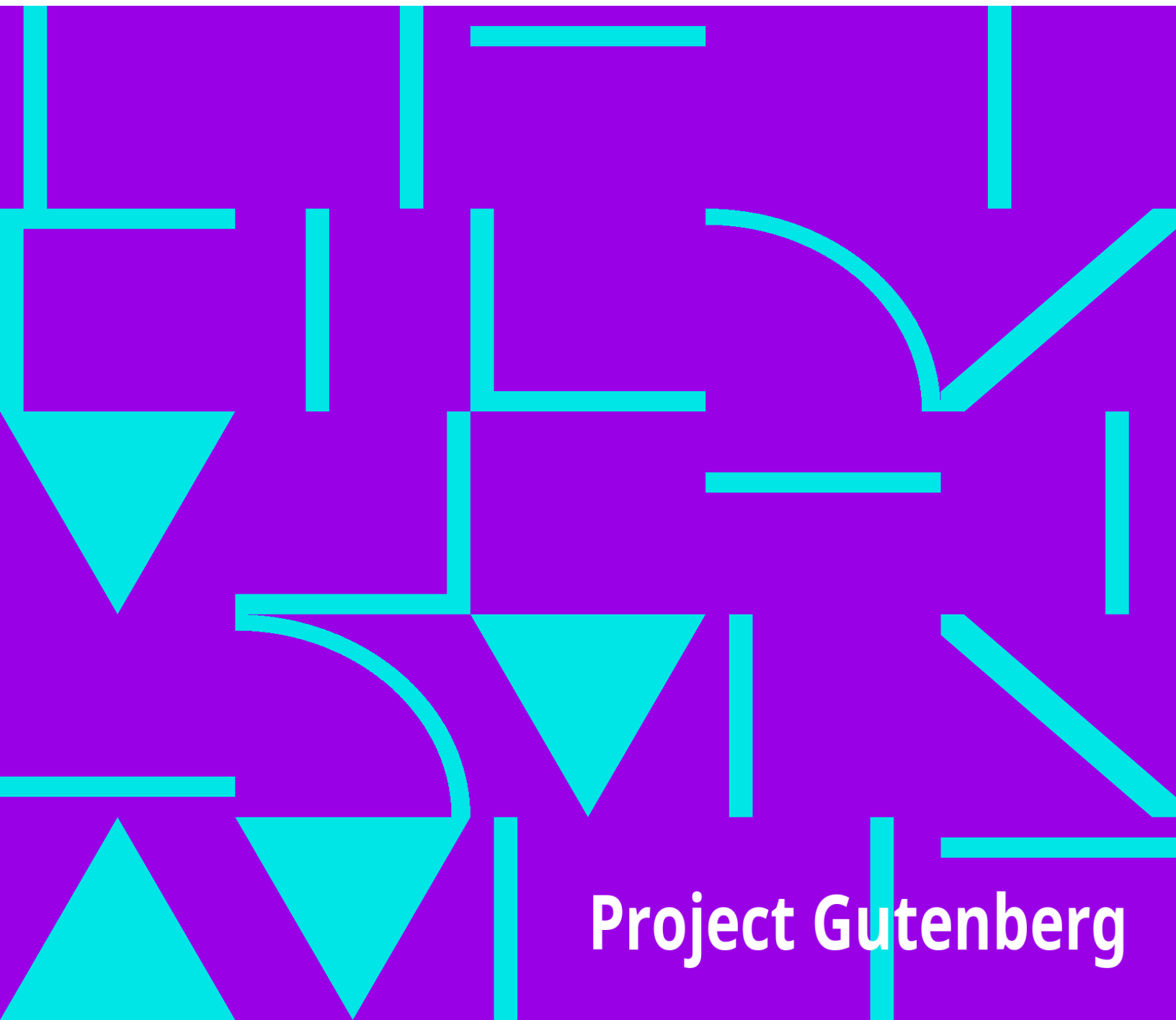


The Goblins' Christmas

Elizabeth Anderson

The bottom half of the image features a complex, abstract geometric pattern. It consists of numerous red lines and shapes of varying lengths and orientations, including straight lines, right angles, and curved segments, all set against a solid black background. The pattern is dense and non-repeating, creating a modern, architectural feel.

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The Goblins' Christmas

Elizabeth Anderson



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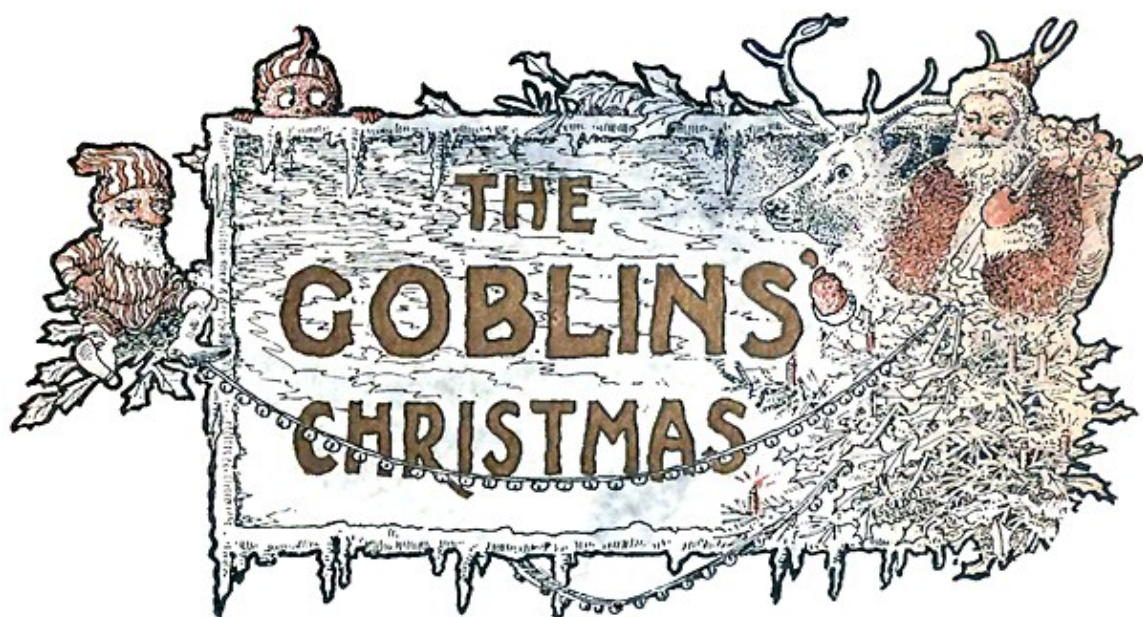
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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE GOBLINS'
CHRISTMAS ***



THE GOBLINS' CHRISTMAS



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The Goblins' Christmas



By

Elizabeth Anderson



Illustrated by Alexander Sharp

Los Angeles
Segnogram Publishing Co.
1908



upon a time I visited Fairy-land and spent a day in Goblin-town. The people there are much like ourselves, only they are very, very small and roguish. They play pranks on one another and have great fun. They are good natured and jolly, and

rarely get angry. But if one does get angry, he quickly recovers his good nature and joins again in the sport.

If a Goblin should continue angry he would take on some visible form. Perhaps he would become a toad or a squirrel, or some other little animal, and would have to live here on the Earth-plane forevermore. But, if he keeps good natured, he can come here and have his fun, and not be seen by any one except a Seer, or very wise person.

The Goblins are gracious to the wise people now, but they were not always so. A long, long time ago, on a Christmas-eve, the Fairy-folk were having great sport. All the little people of the Unseen-world had gathered together in the Earth-realm. There were Brownies, and Gnomes, and Elves;

even some little Cherubs had joined them. They were having a wild dance and a gay time when who should appear but Kris Kringle! Now the Fairies did not know that he was a Magician, or Seer, and so they tried to make sport of him. But Kris by his wonderful magic, changed them into the most beautiful toys. They became straight little jumping-jacks, and dolls in bright dresses, and the dearest little rabbit with

white, soft fur. And somewhere in the bottom of the sleigh one was turned into a cute little Teddy-bear. Then old Kris tucked all these toys into his roomy sleigh, and shook the reins of his waiting steed. "Go on!" he said, "For I've many, many a chimney to reach tonight."

Now this is the tale of "The Goblins' Christmas" that the moonbeams told, as they heard it from the Fairy-Queen, who declares that every word of it is perfectly true.





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To EARL and GEORGIA:



little Man, and tiny
Maid,
Who love the Fairies in the glade,
Who see them in the tangled grass
The Gnomes and Brownies, as they
pass,
Who hear the Sprites from Elf-land
call

Go, frolic with these Brownies
small,
And join these merry sporting
Elves,
But ever be your own sweet selves.



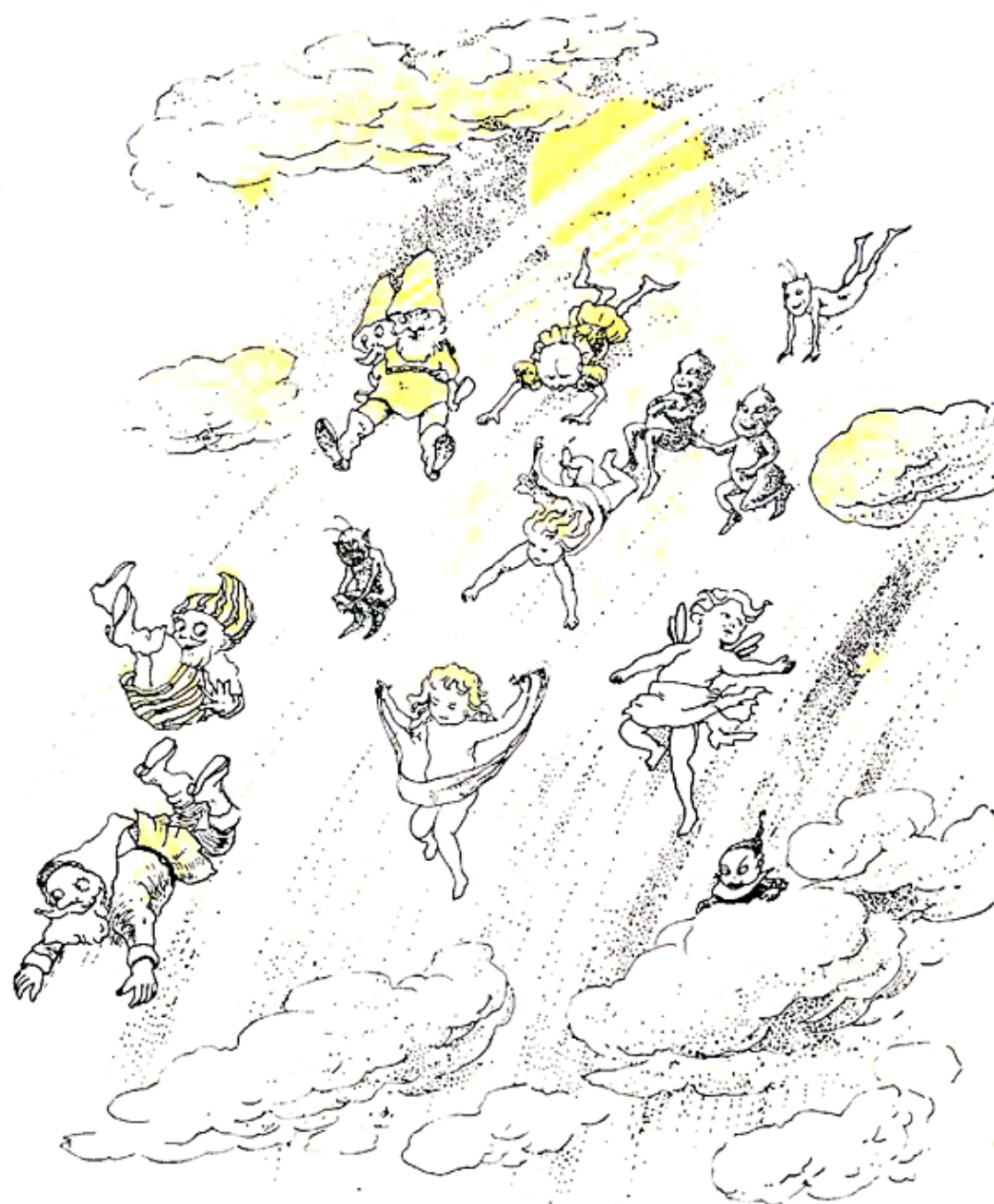


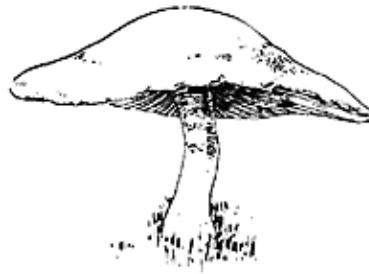
The big bright Moon hung high and
round,
In a densely darkened sky;
The tall pines swayed, and mocked,
and groaned;
The mountains grew so high
That the Man-in-the-Moon came
out and said,
"Ho! Spooks, for a merry
dance."
The winds blow hard, the caverns
roar,
While o'er the earth they
prance.



A Witch and a Goblin led the
sprites;
Out from the sky they sprung;
And down the milky way they slid,
And over a chasm swung.
The streams around ran witches'
broth,
The fumes were strong and
rank.
These Elfin creatures all were
wroth,
While of the stuff they drank.







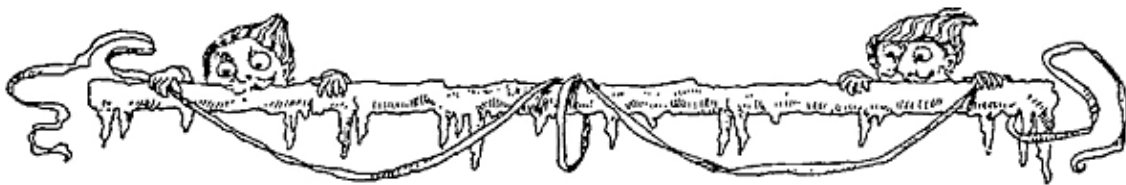
The cunning Moon looked on and
laughed
With a shrill and sneering jibe;
Her soul grew fat to see them
chaffed,
This mad and elfish tribe.

The big black caldron boiled so
high
With food for these queer
mites,
That it lit the world throughout the
sky,
And down came all the
Sprites.





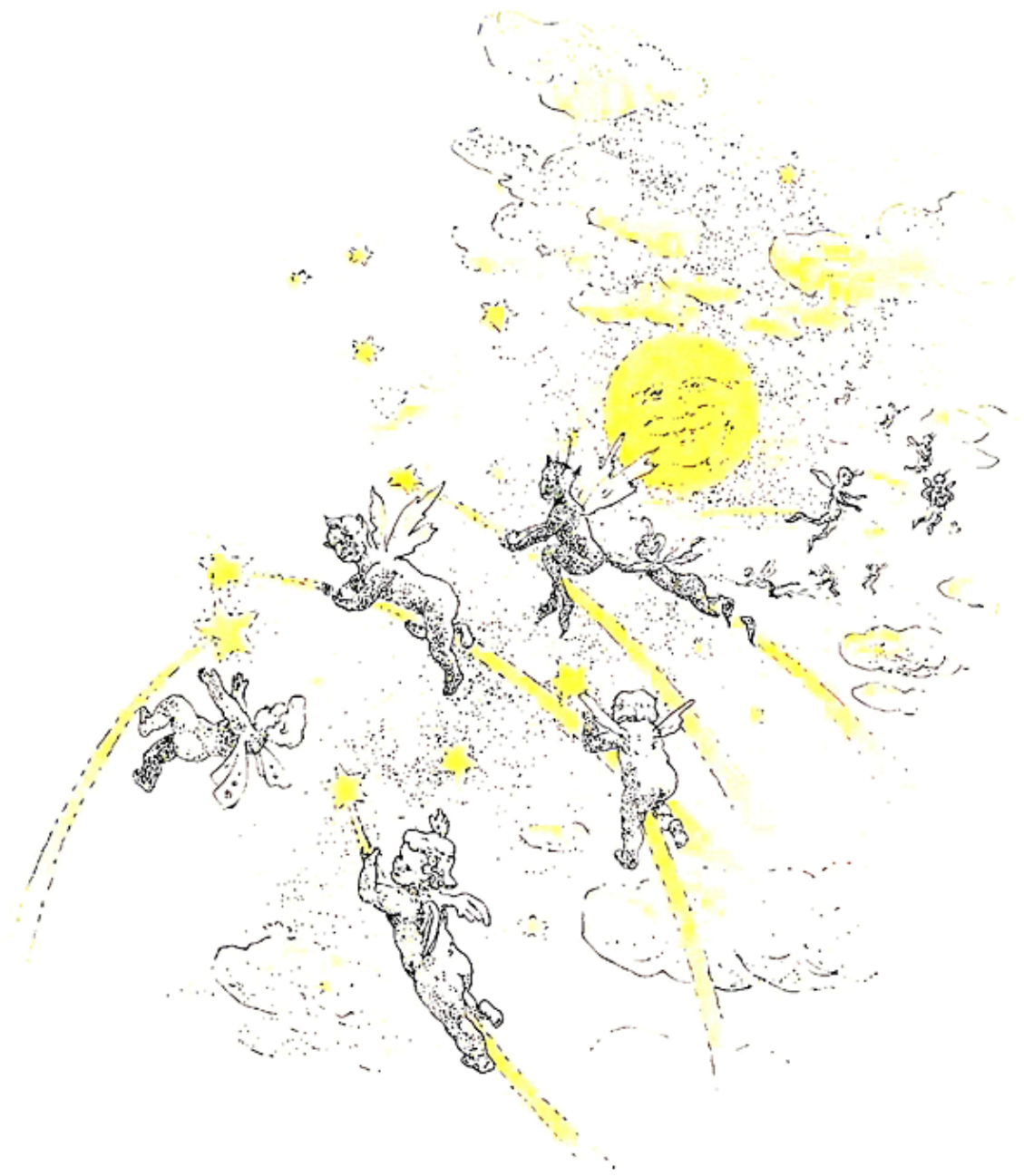
Their mad career upset a star,
As through the air they flew:
It cringed in fear, and shot afar,
And fell where no one knew.
Orion's sword was broke in bits,
Corona's crown was gone,
Capella seemed to lose her wits,
While all so longed for dawn.





Then from the night there came a
 sound
 Of sleigh-bells ringing sweet;
Out of the chaos came a man—
 Kris Kringle—for his
 Christmas treat.
"Ho! Kris!" they cried, "We'll have
 some fun,
 We'll bind the old man down,
We'll tie him up, and toss him o'er
 Into our Goblin-town."







They climbed the sleigh with shout
and din,
To bind his hands and feet;
A hundred strong they clambered in
Our good old Kris to meet.
He sat quite still, with twinkling
eyes,
Then seized his mystic wand,
He raised it up, and waved it round
Stilled was this chattering
band.







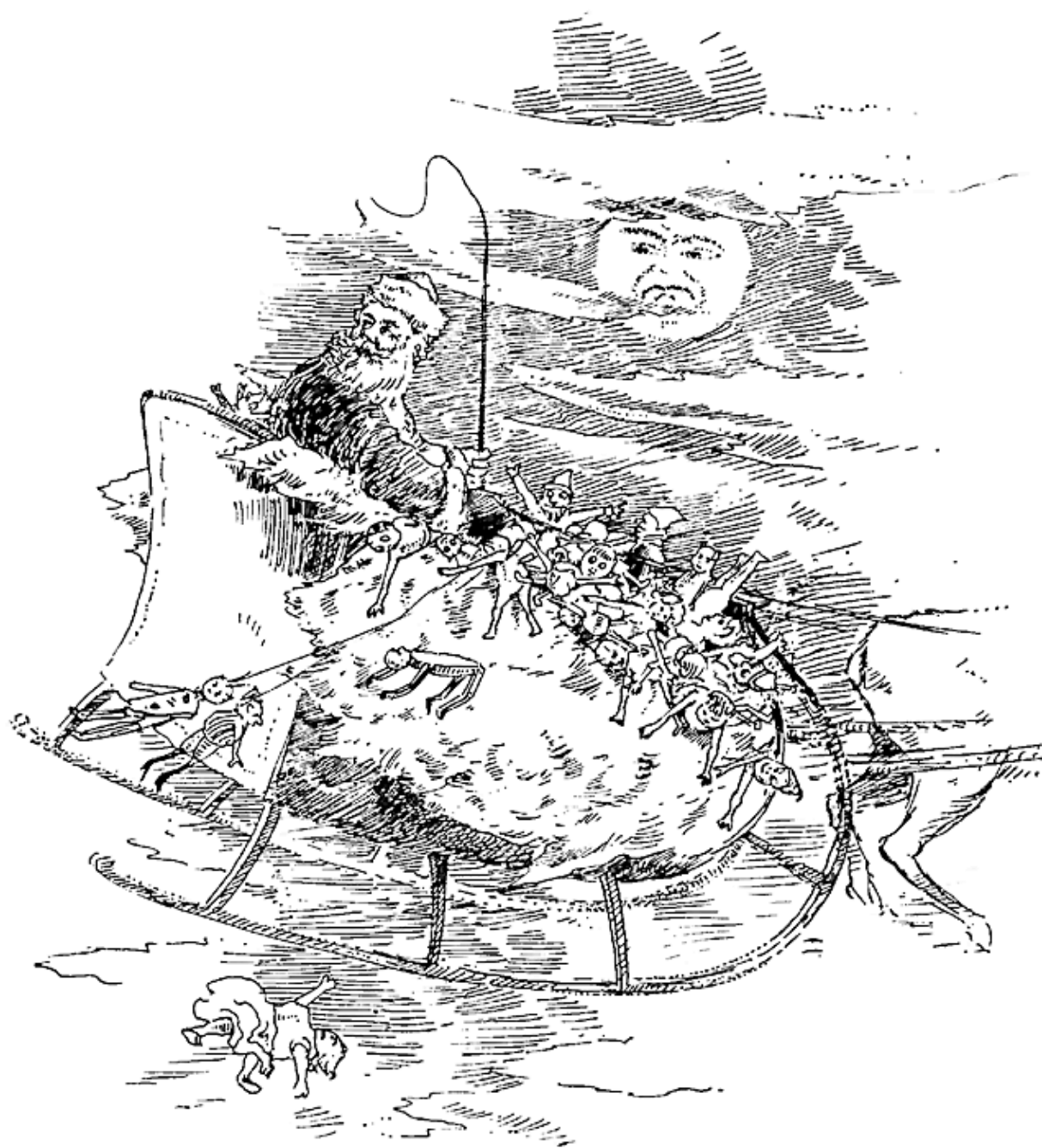
Stiffly stark and still they stood,
Clad in elfish clothes;
Some were wax, and some were
wood,
One had crushed his nose.
"Playthings rare," he said and
smiled,
"For children rich and poor;
Some I'll leave the crippled child,
And some at the orphan's
door."



He shook his reins, and called his
steed

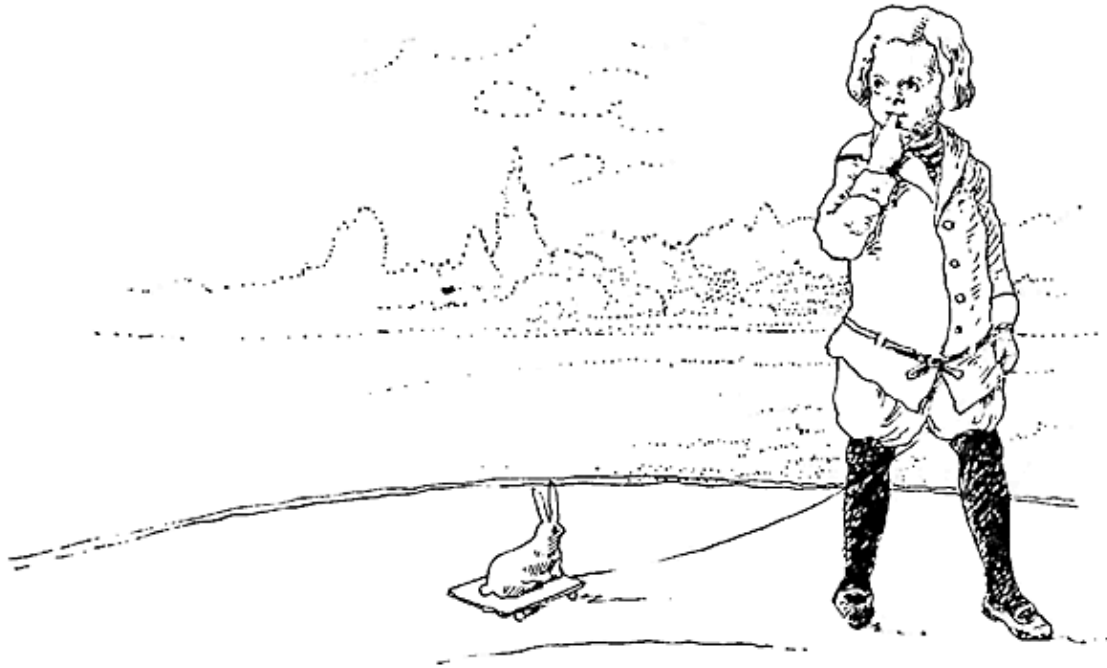
To bear him swiftly on.
Full well it knew its Master's need
To hurry e'er the dawn.
From house to house they
scampered down,
Their sleigh-bells ringing
clear,
Through chimneys in the sleepy
town—
Good Kris and his reindeer.











The windows rattled, the
moonbeams tattled
A tale so strange and queer.
They told how at night, in dire
affright
The Moon had hid in fear.



That he'd called in sport his elfish
court
Of spooks and witches gay,
Each Elfin child, by glee beguiled,

Brought scores of others, they
say.

Then a man appeared, with flowing
beard,
In a sled with a reindeer fleet;
They gathered about with din and
shout,
To bind him hands and feet.



Then the Moon laughed loud at the
gathering crowd,
While he held his sides in
mirth,
To see old Kris in a plight like this,
Toiling o'er the earth.



But alas for the Moon, he had
 laughed like a loon,
 For Kris is a hero of old,
Yes, Kris is a seer; with his small
 reindeer,
 He captured the Goblins bold.

And he changed them, they say in a
 wonderful way,
 To toys, for his Christmas
 cheer.

The big dolls stare with a goblin
air,
The small ones cringe with
fear.



While the moonbeams prattle, I
hear a rattle
Of hoofs on the chimney side;
Then out on the snow I gaze below,
"Hurrah! it's Kris Kringle," I
cried.

Then, sly as a mouse, he entered
the house,
And hung up his treasures so
gay.
Then out with a dash, he sped like a
flash,
Into the night, and away.





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